GG-H-1970
May 4, 1976

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Castroviejo, 5-1/2 inch

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal Agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a suture needle holder of the Castroviejo design.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

GG-I-526	-	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 66	- Steel: Chemical Composition and Hardenability
Fed. Std. No. 123	- Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. 151	- Metal, Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20204.

FSC 6515

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of
MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications, Standards, Drawings and Publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, ATTN: Tariff Publishing Officer, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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National Motor Freight Traffic Classification, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Attn: Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

E-18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI):

Steel Products Manual

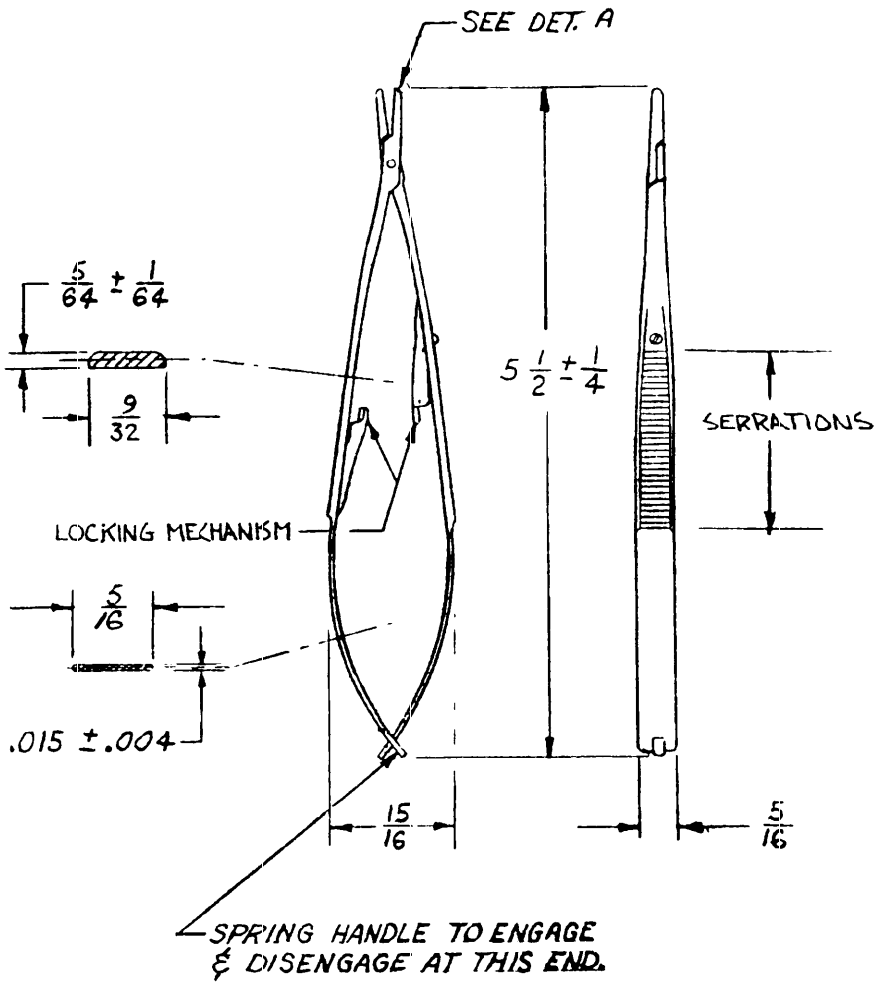
(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Iron and Steel Institute, 1000 16th Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

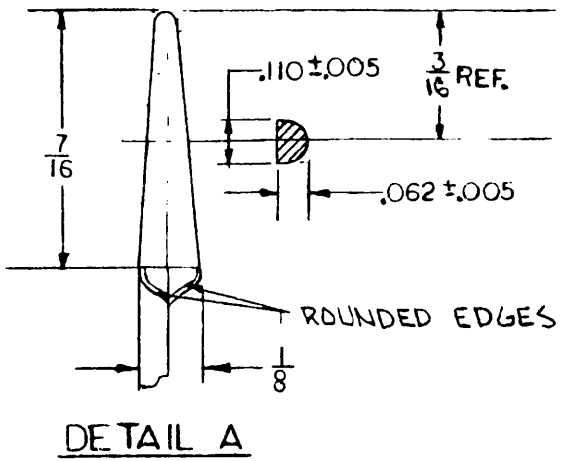
3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General Requirements. The individual part requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of GG-I-526 and those of this specification, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Materials. The instrument in its entirety, except for fasteners, shall be fabricated from AISI Type 420 or 420F stainless steel. Alternatively, the instrument body shall be fabricated from AISI Type 420 stainless steel and the spring from AISI Type 301 stainless steel. Fasteners, such as screws, rivets or pins, shall be fabricated of AISI Type 430F stainless steel.

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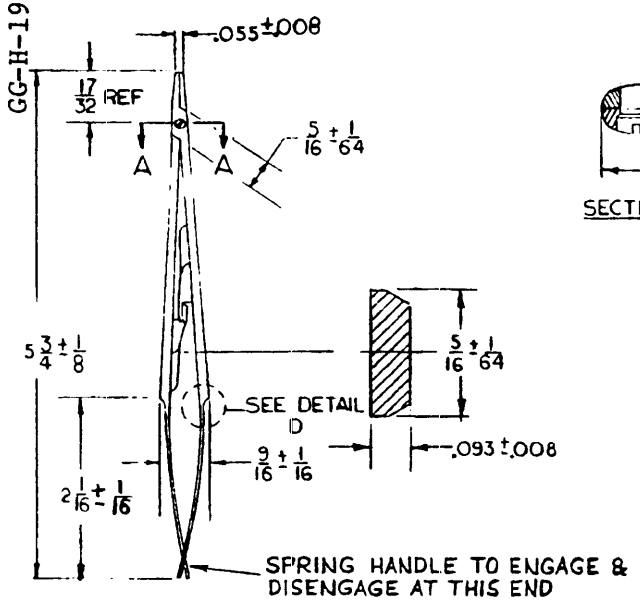


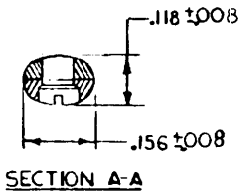


NOTE:- UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED
DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES
TOLERANCES ON FRACTIONS ± 1/32

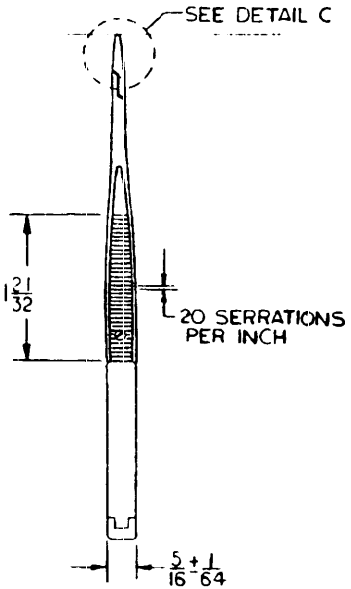
FIGURE 1. Holder, suture needle, Castroviejo - 5-1/2 inch

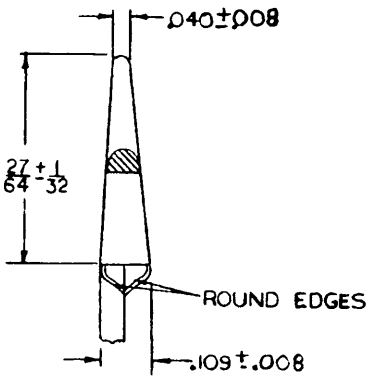
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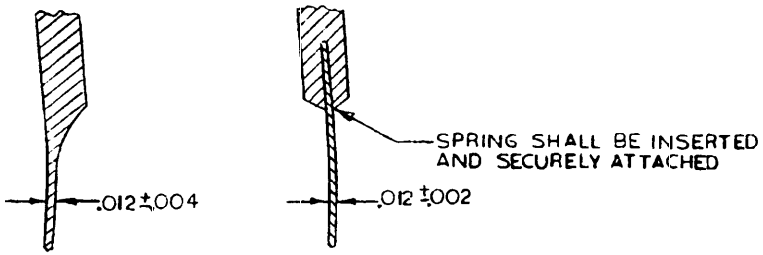
SECTION A-A





DETAIL C

NOTE: UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES TOLERANCES ON FRACTIONS ± 1/32



INTEGRAL BODY SPRING DESIGN

TWO PIECE DESIGN

DETAIL D

ALTERNATE DESIGN

FIGURE 2. Holder, suture needle, Castroviejo - 5-1/2 inch

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3.3 Design and construction. The instrument shall be a needle holder of the Castroviejo design, light model, with spring handle and locking mechanism and an overall length of 5-3/4 inches. It shall be designed so that the body and spring are an integral part. Alternatively, the instrument shall be designed so that the spring shall be inserted into the body and securely attached.

3.3.1 Jaws and locking mechanism. The instrument shall be designed to hold the very finest needles and sutures without having to lock the holder. The jaws when closed shall hold sutures between .050 mm diameter and .020 mm diameter. When open, the locking mechanism shall not be engaged. The jaws shall be fine and smooth with rounded joints and no sharp edges. When tested as specified in 4.5.3, the locking mechanism shall engage easily and the jaws shall close completely.

3.3.2 Dimensions and configuration. The physical dimensions and the configuration of the instrument shall be in accordance with figure 1 or alternatively, Figure 2.

3.3.3 Hardness. When tested as specified in 4.5.1, the finished instrument shall have a Rockwell hardness of C40 to C45, after proper stress relieving.

3.3.4 Corrosion resistance. The instrument shall be corrosion resistant conforming with the requirements of GG-I-526 when tested as specified in 4.5.2.1 and 4.5.2.2.

3.4 Finish. The finished instrument shall have a mirror or satin finish as specified in GG-I-526.

3.4.1 Passivation. As a final finish operation the complete instrument shall be passivated.

3.5 Identification marking. Identification marking of finished instruments shall be in accordance with GG-I-526. In addition, instruments of other than United States origin shall also be marked "stainless".

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The instrument shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and shall be free from surface roughness, burrs, pits, scale, corrosion, sharp edges, or any other defect that will affect life, serviceability or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any

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other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual, and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion-resistant metals may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Inspection lot. The inspection lot shall be determined in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Preparation for delivery. The inspection lot size shall be expressed in units of one fully prepared shipping container, containing complete instruments fully prepared for delivery and made from essentially the same materials and components. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container, containing instruments fully prepared for delivery, with the exception that it need not be sealed. The inspection shall be Inspection Level S-2 and the Acceptable Quality Level shall be 4.0 percent defective in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.3 Sampling for examination. A random sample of holders shall be selected from each lot offered to the Government in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL's) shall be as indicated in table I. The unit of product shall be one instrument.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects (continued)

Categories	Defects
Major	
103	Holder not free from cracks, pits, burrs, sharp edges, tool marks, scale and corrosion.
104	Handles not capable of disengagement.
105	Locking mechanism components not secured to handle.
106	Finish not as specified.
107	Jaws of holder touch when locking mechanism is not engaged.
Minor	
201	Holder not identified as specified.

4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. Each of the fully prepared shipping containers, containing instruments, selected as a sample unit from the lot shall be visually examined to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking conform to this specification. The classification of defects, table IV, shall be used to classify the defects found.

TABLE IV. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing; any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.
Contents	Number of intermediate packages is more or less than required; gross/net weight exceed requirements.

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4.4.1 Examination of closure, waterproofing and banding of container. When the shipping container is required to comply with PPP-B-636, the examination for defects in closure, waterproofing and banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Rockwell Hardness. Hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Test Method E18. A minimum of 5 hardness readings shall be made on test specimens representative of the material used in the fabrication of the instrument or on the finished end item.

4.5.2 Corrosion resistance.

4.5.2.1 Boil test. The instrument shall be subjected to the boil test as described in GG-I-526.

4.5.2.2 Copper sulfate test. The instrument shall be subjected to the copper sulfate test as described in GG-I-526.

4.5.3 Locking test. The locking mechanism of the holder shall be tested for proper function by exerting a slight direct pressure (not lateral pressure) at the serrated portions of the handles. The pressure shall be exerted with the use of one hand, utilizing the thumb and forefinger or middle finger. The lock mechanism components shall be observed for proper and positive holding action and the jaws shall be observed for proper closure. The handles of holder shall then be depressed (in the same manner specified above) and the lock shall be observed for easy disengagement and jaw separation.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Each holder shall be thoroughly cleaned, wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive material and packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC1. A preservative shall not be applied to the holder prior to packaging.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate package. Six unit packages shall be packaged in a snug fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Closure of the box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A. Forty-eight unit packages (288 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each Level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraph of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard box shall be waterproof in accordance with appendix PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Forty-eight unit packages (288 units) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Fiberboard boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. The unit and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The holders are to be used to hold very fine needles and sutures in the practice of general surgery and eye surgery.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Applicable levels of packaging and packing, (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) Quantity (see 5.2.3).
(d) National Stock Number.

6.3 National Stock Number (NSN). This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6515-00-616-9173	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Castroviejo, 5-1/2 inch

6.3 This specification does not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types, etc., which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

6.4 Military requirements. Military requirements shall apply to all instruments purchased by military agencies. Where applicable, military requirements shall be in addition to all other requirements.

6.5 Cleaning procedure caution. Instruments with a satin or sandblast finish shall be cleaned properly with a brush and soap and water (if possible with distilled water) in order to avoid blood deposits which may not be dissolved by cleaning in the ultrasonic cleaner.

Military Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DSA-DM

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:
GSA-FSS
VA-DMS

Project No. 6515-1948

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

GG-H-1970 - Holder, Suture Needle, Castroviejo, 5-1/2 inch

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

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